where their forays in AH 552/1158 CE – only fifteen years before the conquest of Ghazna – seem to have left sparse but distinctive traces, e.g., in burial mounds: "hybrid" burial practices combining a *qibla* orientation of the deceased with unusual underground vaults and octagonal platforms above ground. Indeed, the south- and eastward campaigning armies of Mu'izz al-Din would have continued to encounter varieties not only in tomb structures, but also in burial practices, e.g., in Baluchistan and coastal Makran, where they campaigned in the 1180s (cf. Chapter 6). For these contiguous areas, cf., e.g., Hassan 1991: 79ff.

52. Khazeni's (2009: 13 and *passim*) work on central Iran's Bakhtyari tribes within Qajar realms (late nineteenth–early twentieth centuries) described its most useful source, *Tarikh-i Bakhtyari*, as "a tribal history and perhaps the first ethnography in the Persian language," compiled between 1909 and 1911; it was a sweeping combination of relevant passages from official Persian chronicles and "original material … devoted to the oral histories and geographical lore of the tribes, including … organization, administration, and customs." Historical empires originating in nomadic pastoralism, such as the Qara- or Ilak-khanids (mid-tenth–early thirteenth centuries) and the Qarakhitai (1087–1143; cf. Chapter 1), evince divergent literary developments strongly impacted by contact with the Islamic-Persianate *ecumene*: the Qara- or Ilak-khanid Satoq Bughra Khan Abd al-Karim's (d. *c.* 955 CE) embrace of Islam led not only to a wave of conversion among other Turks, arguably it also led to the creation of a *Turkic* – rather than Persian – literary tradition beginning in the 1070s. Cf. Biran 2012; Vàsàry 2015: 17ff. By contrast, modern scholars of the unconverted Qarakhitai still come across great difficulties when searching for primary sources, not least because of "the irregular record keeping of the nomadic Khitans and the unusually long time that passed from … 1125 to the compilation of the [Chinese *Liao shi*] in 1344–45" (Biran 2005: 4).
53. For the larger juridical and even theological debates in which the Karramiyya engaged with other *madhhab*s, see Zysow 1988: 585 and *passim*; Zysow 2011/2012: pts iv and v.
54. Cf. Edwards 1991: 69.
55. Cf. Najimi 2015: 158–163 for a detailed description of the manufacture of inscriptions in brick and stucco; see also Chapters 2 and 3, for a discussion of the availability of local practitioners of the architectural culture prevalent throughout Khurasan. In the context of the Jam-Firuzkuh *minar* – cf. *infra* in main text – Lintz (2013: 96–97) also discussed collaboration among builders, artisans, theologians, and patrons.
56. For the typical career of a purchased Turk slave, see Barthold (1968: 227–228), who derived the trajectory from the Saljuq *vizir* Nizam al-Mulk's *Siyasat-nama*. For the Ghaznavids in particular, Allegranzi (2014: 113–114) summarized Baihaqi's praise of Mas'ud I's skills as architect/engineer (*muhandis*) (also Bosworth 1973: 139–141). Although this could have been rhetorical flourish in praise of his patron, it nonetheless appears that Sultan Mahmud had been diligent about the education of his sons in Persian and Arabic *adab*, and the early Ghaznavid sultans' courts "[u]ndoubtedly … became brilliant